

LADDER SAFETY

Correct selection, 4-to-1 setup, securing and three-point contact.

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Portable ladders are for short-duration, light work and do not replace a work platform. Select the correct type and length, inspect before use, set on firm level ground at approximately a 4-to-1 angle, extend above the landing and secure against movement.

KEY HAZARDS



CRITICAL VALUES TO VERIFY IN THE FIELD

4:1

Non-self-supporting ladder setup ratio

0,9 m

Extension above the landing

3 points

Continuous contact while climbing



REMEMBER - SERNEM

S

Stop and think

E

Evaluate the risk

R

Remove or reduce

N

Never assume

E

Ensure protection

M

Monitor and communicate

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STANDARDS AND FIELD REQUIREMENTS

OSHA Subpart X addresses ladder capacity, condition, setup and use together. Manufacturer labels and local requirements also apply.

OSHA 1926.1053(a)(1)

CAPACITY

Portable ladders must support at least four times the maximum intended load, subject to the stated exceptions.

OSHA 1926.1053(b)(1)

INTENDED USE

Use a ladder only for its designed purpose; do not convert it into a closed stepladder or improvised platform.

OSHA 1926.1053(b)(5)

FIRM LEVEL BASE

Use portable ladders on firm, level, non-slippery surfaces unless secured to prevent displacement.

OSHA 1926.1053(b)(13)

UPPER ACCESS

For upper-level access, extend side rails at least 0.9 m above the landing or provide equivalent secure handholds.

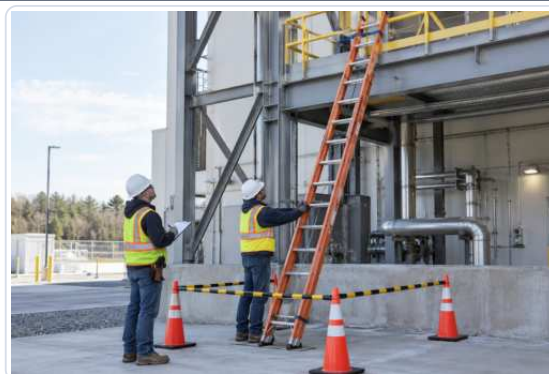
MINIMUM EVIDENCE BEFORE START

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Ladder inspection record | ☐ Load-rating label |
| ☐ Setup-area check | ☐ Top/bottom securing |
| ☐ Electrical-hazard assessment | ☐ User training |

SUPERVISOR DISCUSSION POINTS

- Why may this task be done from a ladder rather than a platform?
- How do we check the 4-to-1 ratio in the field?
- How will three-point contact be maintained while moving tools?

CORRECT LADDER SETUP AND INSPECTION



4-to-1 angle - Firm base - Landing extension - Top/bottom securing - Clear access

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CRITICAL CONTROL MEASURES (HIERARCHY OF CONTROLS)

1. SELECT SAFER ACCESS

Use a platform, scaffold or MEWP for long-duration, two-handed or heavy work.

2. SELECT THE RIGHT LADDER

Verify type, length, load rating and material for any electrical exposure.

3. SET UP AND SECURE

Provide the 4-to-1 angle, firm base, landing extension and top/bottom securing.

4. USE THREE-POINT CONTACT

Face the ladder, carry tools in a bag and never overreach.

CRITICAL WARNING



Do not stand on the top step, tie ladders together, conceal damage with paint or lean a ladder against moving equipment. Tag and remove defective ladders from service.

SITE CHECKLIST (BEFORE STARTING WORK)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Correct ladder selected | ☐ Label and load rating legible |
| ☐ Rails, rungs and feet sound | ☐ Ground firm and level |
| ☐ 4-to-1 angle achieved | ☐ Top and bottom secured |
| ☐ Adequate extension above landing | ☐ Doors and traffic controlled |
| ☐ Three-point contact will be maintained | |

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ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

Project / Site: _____ Date: _____

Presented by: _____ Work area: _____

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			